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Citizenship: German

Jan Kemper

Research Interests

- Primary Field: Public Economics/Finance
- Secondary Fields: Political Economy

Education

University of Mannheim — Mannheim, Germany
Ph.D. in Economics — 2022 - 2027 *(expected)*
- Advisors: Philipp Dörrenberg, Friedrich Heinemann

University of Konstanz — Konstanz, Germany
M.Sc. in Political Economy (GPA: A) — 2019 - 2022

University of Potsdam — Potsdam, Germany
B.Sc. in Politics and Economics (GPA: A) — 2015 - 2019
- Exchange Semester: Tbilisi State University (Tbilisi, Georgia)
- Exchange Semester: University of International Business and Economics (Beijing, China)

References

Prof. Philipp Dörrenberg
University of Mannheim
doerrenberg@uni-mannheim.de

Prof. Friedrich Heinemann
Heidelberg University
friedrich.heinemann@zew.de

Professional Experience

Centre for European Economic Research | Mannheim, Germany — 10/2023 - now
- Researcher in the Department of Corporate Taxation and Public Finance
- Organizer of the ZEW Public Finance Conference 2024 and 2025

International Monetary Fund | Washington, D.C., USA — 06/2026 - 08/2026
- FIP internship program
- Fiscal Affairs Department
- Research on digitization of revenue administrations
- Policy report on impact assessment methodology

German Business Panel - University of Mannheim | Mannheim, Germany — 10/2022 - 09/2023
- Doctoral research associate working on adaptive experiments (Prof. Davud Rostam-Afschar)

University of Konstanz | Konstanz, Germany — 10/2019 - 09/2021
- Research assistant - Chair of economic policy (Prof. Sebastian Findeisen)

University of Konstanz | Konstanz, Germany — 07/2021 - 12/2021
- Research assistant - Policy evaluation of UN World Food Program (Prof. Steffen Eckhard)

Centre for European Economic Research | Mannheim, Germany — 05/2021 - 07/2021
- Intern in the Department of Corporate Taxation and Public Finance

Georgian Centre for Security and Development | Tbilisi, Georgia — 02/2018 - 04/2018
- Intern

Teaching Experience

University of Mannheim | Mannheim, Germany 10/2023 - 02/2026
- Tutor Advanced Econometrics

University of Konstanz | Konstanz, Germany 10/2019 - 09/2021
- Tutor Introduction to Economics
- Tutor Introduction to Academic Work

Conferences and Seminars

- **2nd Kiel-CEPR Conference on Monetary Policy - Central Bank Independence in the Spotlight**, Berlin (Poster) 2026
- **53rd Annual Meeting of the European Public Choice Society**, Madrid (Presenter) 2026
- **81st Annual Congress of the International Institute of Public Finance (IIPF)**, Nairobi (Presenter) 2025
- **Network for Empirical Tax Research (NeSt)**, Berlin (Poster) 2025
- **KIZ Political Economy Workshop**, Munich (Poster) 2025
- **Bonn-Cologne-Frankfurt-Mannheim PhD Conference**, Frankfurt (Presenter) 2025
- **European Public Choice Society**, Riga (Presenter) 2025
- **The Political Economy of Democracy and Dictatorship**, Münster (Presenter) 2025
- **80th Annual Congress of the International Institute of Public Finance (IIPF)**, Prague (Presenter) 2024
- **European Public Choice Society**, Braga (Presenter) 2022

Training Schools

- **Automated Image and Video Data Analysis**
  GESIS, Mannheim 2023

Scholarships

- **Ph.D. Scholarship**
  German Research Foundation (DFG) 2022-2023

Referee Service

- European Journal of Political Economy (2), Public Choice (2), Constitutional Political Economy, International Tax and Public Finance, The Economists' Voice, Bank of Lithuania Discussion Paper Series

Skills

Languages: German (native), English (full professional proficiency), Mandarin (elementary)

Programming: `R, Python, Stata, Microsoft Office (Advanced); SQL (basics)`

Publications

Earning While Learning: How to Run Batched Bandit Experiments (2026, joint with Davud Rostam-Afschar) - *Stata Journal*

Researchers collect data in most experiments not all at once but sequentially over a period of time. This allows to observe outcomes early and adapt the treatment assignment to reduce the costs of inferior treatments. This article discusses multi-armed-bandit-type adaptive experimental designs and algorithms for balancing exploration of treatment effects and exploitation of better treatments. By design, bandits break usual asymptotics and make inference difficult. We show how a batched bandit design allows for valid confidence intervals and compare coverage of the Batched Bandit estimator in Monte Carlo simulations. We introduce bbandits in Stata, a tool for easily running Monte Carlo simulations to assist the design and implementation of experiments before data are collected, interactively running own bandit experiments, and analysing adaptively collected data. bbandits implements three popular treatment assignment algorithms: ε-first, ε-greedy, and Thompson sampling. The **bbandits** command facilitates estimation, inference, and visualization.

Working Papers

Taxing Secondary Residents (joint with Tommy Krieger) - *submitted*

Using municipal data from Germany, we examine how people adjust their residential situation due to a second home tax and how these adjustments affect the municipal budget and housing market. Results from Difference-in- Differences analyses suggest that such a tax largely decreases the number of secondary residents. We also find that many people turn a secondary into a primary residence to avoid the tax. A consequence of this reaction is that most municipalities generate low direct revenues. However, there are notable indirect effects because formula-based intergovernmental transfers increase. Touristic municipalities also have higher income tax revenues. Real estate prices and rents remain unchanged.

ECB Council Members' Objectives and Public Debt at Home – Evidence from an AI-Based Textual Analysis (joint with Friedrich Heinemann) - *R & R Journal of International Money and Finance*

By analyzing more than 4,600 speeches given between the establishment of the ECB and the summer of 2024, we examine the attention that ECB Governing Council members pay to different policy objectives. In addition to the primary objective of price stability, our analysis considers the following possible secondary objectives: financial stability, government bond market stability, public debt, climate protection, and distribution. On the methodological side, we take advantage of the recently improved access to large language models (LLM) and use GPT models to identify the coverage of these possible objectives and the associated support. We use two-way fixed effects regressions to search for a link between a country's public debt level and the objective function of its representatives. The results suggest that objectives have become more diverse in recent years. The positioning of central bankers correlates with the debt-to-GDP ratio, where an increase in public debt is associated with increasingly dovish statements by national central bankers.

Inference for Batched Adaptive Experiments (joint with Davud Rostam-Afschar) - *submitted*

This note suggests a BOLS (batched ordinary least squares) test statistic for inference of treatment effects in adaptive experiments. The statistic provides a precision-equalizing aggregation of per-period treatment-control differences under heteroskedasticity. The combined test statistic is a normalized average of per-period heteroskedastic z-statistics and can be used to construct asymptotically valid confidence intervals. We provide simulation results comparing rejection rates in the typical case with few treatment periods and few (or many) observations per batches.

Work in Progress

Taxing Travellers (joint with Sebastian Blesse and Valentin Kissmann) *Draft coming soon*

Tourism is a key income source for cities while also exerting negative externalities on local economies. We estimate the causal effects of local tourism taxes on tourism demand and hotel prices using municipal-level data from Germany. Exploiting staggered tax adoptions across more than 700 municipalities between 2005 and 2023, we implement event-study designs based on monthly administrative data on overnight stays and accommodation supply. We complement this analysis with newly web-scraped hotel price data from Booking.com to study tax pass-through and analyze housing market implications of the tax. Tourism taxes reduce overnight stays by about 3.5 percent in the first year after adoption which corresponds to a tax elasticity of -0.7. There are strong heterogeneities. In popular places (big cities, fiscally successful cities, touristic cities) the elasticities are negligible. Hotel prices increase by roughly 3.3 percent, implying a substantial average pass-through rate of 0.66 to consumers. Pass-through is complete in the high-price hotel segment but close to zero in the low-price segment. We do not find evidence for effects on housing markets.

The Horizon Problem of Public Investments (single-authored) *Early stage*

E-Filing for Personal Income Taxes - Early Evidence from Senegal's Mon Espace Personnel (MEP) Reform (joint with Mitali Das, Supriyo De, Cheryl Li, Serge Mani)

Pre-doctoral publications

Heinemann, Friedrich and Jan Kemper (2021), The ECB Under the Threat of Fiscal Dominance – The Individual Central Banker Dimension, The Economists' Voice 18(1), 5-30.

Policy Briefs

Heinemann, Friedrich and Jan Kemper (2022), Inflation of Objectives Instead of Focus on Inflation? Evidence on the ECB Objective Function from a Textual Analysis, ZEW-Kurzexpertise No. 22-07, Mannheim

Heinemann, Friedrich and Jan Kemper (2026) *in German*, Falke oder Taube in der Nachfolge von Christine Lagarde an der EZB-Spitze? Einsichten aus einer KI-Analyse öffentlicher Reden, ZEW Policy Brief No. 26-05, Mannheim

Heinemann, Friedrich and Jan Kemper (2026), ECB Monitor: Methodology, ZEW ECB Monitor, Mannheim

Heinemann, Friedrich and Jan Kemper (2026), ECB Monitor Quarterly Report Q2 2026, ZEW ECB Monitor, Mannheim

Heinemann, Friedrich and Jan Kemper (2026), ECB Monitor Quarterly Report Q3 2026, ZEW ECB Monitor, Mannheim